

# Draft Box - Match Engine & Tactics Rulebook

This PDF summarizes the gameplay systems used by Draft Box after the V 1.2.0 engine updates.

## Draft and Formation Control

Each drafter builds an XI from real 2026 World Cup squad players. During the draft, formation can be changed as long as already drafted players still fit the new position-group counts.

After all 11 slots are filled, the drafter can select a filled pitch slot and then another compatible slot in the same position group to move or swap players before locking tactical style.

## Team Chemistry

Chemistry modifies team power through correct position fit, balanced defense/midfield/attack structure, natural linkage, Game Changer leadership and penalties for out-of-position picks.

Human draft squads can become stronger than their raw average if the shape is coherent; they can also lose power if too many players are forced into weak roles.

## Tactical Style Calculation

Every team locks one style: Defensive, Balanced, Gegenpress, Possession, or Counter Attack.

A style contributes engine modifiers for Attack, Defense, Tempo, Risk, Press, Control, Transition, Set Pieces and Star Moment.

Attack and Defense multiply the core team ratings directly. Tempo, Risk and Transition increase shot volume and counter-attacking xG. Control and Press influence possession, territory, pass accuracy and chance stability. Set Pieces raises corner/foul conversion value. Star Moment changes the chance that a Game Changer creates a late special action.

Risk can improve attacking ceiling but also raises foul and card volatility. Matchup edges are intentionally small: Counter can punish pressure, Possession can slow chaotic games, Defensive can absorb risk, Gegenpress can generate late pressure, and Balanced avoids major weaknesses.

## Player Overall Impact

Player quality uses a stronger curve than a flat average. Elite 85-91 players have larger influence on goals, assists, saves, penalties and late match events, while squad-depth players still matter through chemistry and role fit.

Captain bonus is applied before role weighting. Human teams receive a 1.2x Attack and Defense boost only against AI teams; human vs human and AI vs AI remain neutral.

## Expected Goals and Results

The engine combines Attack, Defense, chemistry, tactical style, formation edge, morale, cards, keeper quality, set pieces, transitions and star moments into expected goals.

Goals are sampled from a Poisson distribution around expected goals, so stronger teams win more often but never automatically. Knockout draws go to extra time and then penalties.

## Predict Chance

The lineup reveal prediction now follows the same model as the match engine. Championship chance uses weighted player overalls, chemistry, tactical style, Game Changer threat, formation fit and the relative strength of all 48 teams.

The panel also projects goal focus, creator focus and pressure player using the same role and quality weights that live match events use.

## **Spoiler and Progression**

In Spoiler Mode, multiplayer users advance stage by stage together. Players mark Ready for the next stage, and the UI shows who is ready. If a user is eliminated, later results stay hidden until the tournament is fully finished.

## **Awards and Review**

The final screen includes tournament awards and a two-sided knockout bracket. Engine Match Review explains why each match tilted using xG, possession, shots, passing, saves, cards, chemistry, tactical style, star moments, extra time and penalties.